Oliver Black

Palantir Forward Deployed Engineer & University of Cambridge Computer Science

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Education

University of Cambridge /
Computer Science BA & MA
2016 - 2019, CAMBRIDGE, UK

One of the most intensive & theoretically grounded Computer Science courses.

Chinese Language Institute /
Mandarin Chinese - HSK 5
2015 - 2016 - 10 MONTHS, GUILIN, CHINA

4 hours 1-on-1 a day immersive course.

Hills Road Sixth Form College /
A Levels - 4A*
2013-2015, CAMBRIDGE, UK

Prior Education /
A Level French & Spanish
2010 - 6 MONTHS, VALENCIA, SPAIN
2007 - 6 MONTHS, VENANSAULT, FRANCE

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Programming

Python • Java • TypeScript/React • SQL • YAML • Rust • C

Palantir Foundry & AIP • Agentic AI • Spark • Kubernetes • AWS/Azure/GCP • Edge Compute • Data Modelling • Systems Architecture

AI-native full-stack engineering, leveraging agentic coding workflows and LLM automation from rapid prototyping through to production deployment.

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Languages

English - Native
Mandarin Chinese - Fluent (CEFR C1)
French & Spanish - Ex-Fluent

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Hobbies & Other

International Finalist Superbrain 2019

Wing Chun • Skiing • Sailing • Squash • Football • Hiking • Running • Board Games

Gold Duke of Edinburgh Award

London, UK

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Employment History

Palantir / Forward Deployed Engineer, Technical Lead & Architect
SEPTEMBER 2019 - CURRENT, LONDON, UK

Built and designed operational apps to deliver value for customers, including managing data & performance at huge scale, and contributing to Palantir Foundry Product.

Forward Deployed Engineer:

- *Hands-on Implementation*: Built data pipelines, data models, backends and applications on Palantir Foundry.
- *Product Development*: Contributed directly to the Palantir Foundry product to build critical features and close gaps.
- *Production Deployments*: Delivered operational workflows on-site at NHS, MHCLG, Airbus and other customers.

Technical Lead:

- *AI in Healthcare*: Directed engineering teams delivering AI-powered operational tools into NHS hospitals.
- *Public Sector & Utilities*: Led technical execution for the NHS FDP, UK Government's Homes for Ukraine scheme (Kluz Prize winner) and EnBW.
- *People Leadership*: Drove career progression and technical mentorship for engineers outside direct team.

Architect:

- *NHS FDP Architecture*: Designed the target data architecture across NHS England, including migrating the legacy analytical estate to FDP.
- *FDP Health Decision Suite*: Designed the frameworks enabling acute trusts to build and deploy bespoke operational apps on FDP.
- *Cloud Connectivity*: Led architecture for Palantir platform integrations with Microsoft Azure.

Pioneered production agentic workflows across client deployments and internal engineering.

Solarflare & Kynesim / Embedded Software Development Intern
SUMMERS 2014 - 2018 - 6 MONTHS, CAMBRIDGE, UK

Developed low-level C and Python software for high-performance network interface cards and embedded Linux systems across multiple summer placements.

Personal Projects

Built projects outside of work/school, home automation, mobile apps, and embedded software, including:

IPv6 Router in Rust (Cambridge Dissertation): Built a custom software-defined IPv6 router and packet-forwarding engine in Rust.

Get in touch if you have any questions.

LinkedIn • Facebook • Medium • GitHub • StackExchange • X • Weibo